The SIT received an anonymous call towards the end of June. The caller refused to identify himself. There were instructions that any such call would have to be entertained, irrespective of whether the caller was willing to give his/her name and contact details. Incidentally, the anonymous caller had a long story to share, which allowed the SIT communication experts to trace the caller. He was picked up within two hours with the assurance that his identity would never be disclosed. The caller had no choice. He told them his story all over again.

The caller, from Saidapet, had an unexpected guest, Bhaskaran, from Jaffna. They had met at a refugee camp in Vellore, Tamil Nadu, sometime in 1987. Bhaskaran said he was looking for a house on rent but facing problems because he was a Sri Lankan citizen. Would he be able to help? The natural query from the Saidapet man was, ‘Who will be staying in the house? Another Sri Lankan?’ Bhaskaran, he claimed, was not comfortable answering the question. But he appeared desperate to get a house on rent. But the caller said he was not willing to help until he knew the identity of the tenants, particularly after the assassination.

Bhaskaran finally gave in. He reluctantly said his daughter and son-in-law were being held hostage by Sivarasan and his gang in a house at MR Nagar, Kodungaiyur. The Saidapet man could not believe what Bhaskaran had told him. However, he soon realized that Bhaskaran was in a soup. He told him to go to the police and report this. Bhaskaran left and, unfortunately, the caller didn’t think of asking for the address of the house where Bhaskaran’s daughter and son-in-law were being held hostage. After discussing the matter with his family, he picked up the phone and called the SIT.

Murugan was asked to give details of the hideouts in MR Nagar. He could not describe the location. The SIT took him to the area in one of the bulletproof cars used by the Cobra commandos of the CRPF. But even that didn’t work. However, he revealed that Bhaskaran could be traced to a refugee camp in Tuticorin. Luckily, the Tuticorin Police found him there and brought him to Malligai. In his interrogation, he gave the SIT the address of Sivarasan’s hideout—in Everready Colony in Kodungaiyur. That